

Post-incident review PIR-2025-020

Identity Platform: delayed processing

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 27 June 2025, Identity Platform experienced delayed processing in production (AU Southeast) for about 18 minutes. A latency threshold alert fired for the service's main endpoint. Investigation found that the database ran out of connections under end-of-month batch load.

Impact

Users of Identity Platform saw delayed processing for about 18 minutes. The service owner, Identity and Access, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:03 First signal received.
- 09:30 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:57 Likely cause identified.
- 10:18 Mitigation applied.
- 10:59 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that the database ran out of connections under end-of-month batch load.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.
- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.